

COMMUNICATIVE ENGLISH

Unit-I: Grammar and Vocabulary

Comprehensive Study Notes for HPU BCA

1. Verb Forms (V1, V2, V3, V4, V5)

1.1 Introduction

Verb forms are essential for constructing grammatically correct sentences. The correct form of a verb depends on the tense, subject, and context of the sentence.

1.2 Types of Verb Forms

Form	Description	Example
Base Form (V1)	Original form of verb	go, eat, play
Past Form (V2)	Simple past tense	went, ate, played
Past Participle (V3)	Used with have/has/had	gone, eaten, played
Present Participle (V4)	V1 + ing	going, eating, playing
Third Person Singular (V5)	V1 + s/es	goes, eats, plays

1.3 Rules for Using Correct Verb Forms

Rule	Description	Example
Subject-Verb Agreement	Verb agrees with subject in number	He goes (not go)
Tense Consistency	Maintain same tense throughout	She studied and passed (not studies)
Irregular Verbs	Special forms for past tense	go → went (not goed)
Auxiliary Verbs	Use helping verbs correctly	She has gone (not have went)

1.4 Solved Examples

#	Question	Answer	Explanation
1	She ____ (go) to school every day.	goes	Third person singular, so verb takes "s/es."
2	They ____ (play) cricket when it started raining.	were playing	Past continuous for action in progress interrupted by another past action.
3	I ____ (finish) my homework already.	have finished	Present perfect for completed action with present relevance.
4	The train ____ (leave) before I reached the station.	had left	Past perfect for action completed before another past action.
5	He ____ (live) in this city since 2010.	has been living / has lived	Present perfect continuous for action continuing from past to present.

2. Subject-Verb Agreement

2.1 Basic Rule

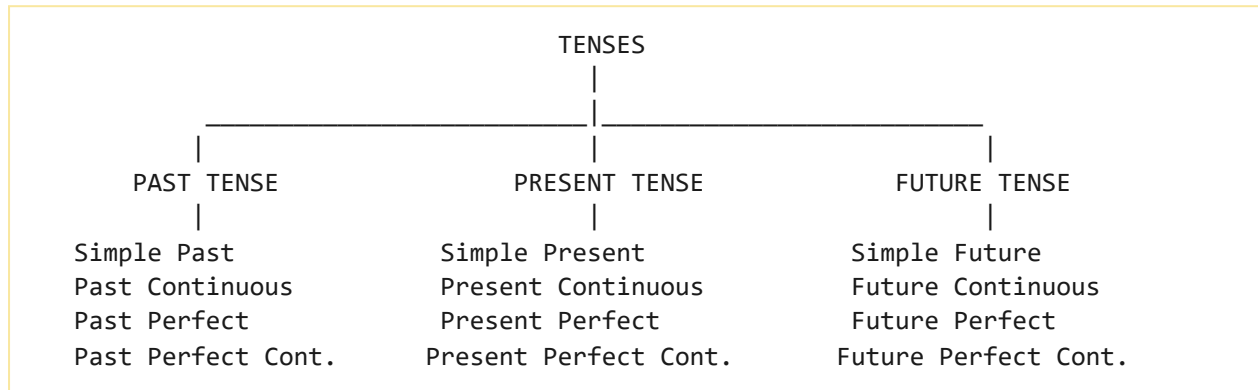
A singular subject takes a singular verb; a plural subject takes a plural verb.

2.2 Key Rules with Examples

Rule	Example
Singular subject + singular verb (V5)	She writes beautifully.
Plural subject + plural verb (V1)	They write beautifully.
Two singular subjects joined by <i>and</i> take plural verb	Rahul and Priya are coming.
Subjects joined by <i>or/nor</i> – verb agrees with the nearer subject	Either the teacher or the students are responsible.
<i>Each, every, either, neither</i> take singular verb	Each student has completed the assignment.
Collective nouns take singular verb (when group acts as one)	The committee has made its decision.
Uncountable nouns take singular verb	Information is power.
Titles of books, films, etc. take singular verb	"The Chronicles of Narnia" is a classic.

3. Tenses

3.1 Classification of Tenses



3.2 Present Tense

Tense	Form	Example
Simple Present	V1 / V1 + s/es	She reads books.
Present Continuous	is/am/are + V1 + ing	She is reading now.
Present Perfect	has/have + V3	She has read the book.
Present Perfect Continuous	has/have been + V1 + ing	She has been reading for two hours.

3.3 Past Tense

Tense	Form	Example
Simple Past	V2	She read a book.
Past Continuous	was/were + V1 + ing	She was reading when I called.

Past Perfect	had + V3	She had read the book before the exam.
Past Perfect Continuous	had been + V1 + ing	She had been reading for two hours.

3.4 Future Tense

Tense	Form	Example
Simple Future	will/shall + V1	She will read a book.
Future Continuous	will be + V1 + ing	She will be reading at 8 pm.
Future Perfect	will have + V3	She will have read the book by then.
Future Perfect Continuous	will have been + V1 + ing	She will have been reading for two hours.

3.5 Solved Examples: Tense Conversion

#	Question	Answer
1	Change to Present Continuous: She writes a letter.	She is writing a letter.
2	Change to Simple Past: They play cricket.	They played cricket.
3	Change to Present Perfect: He went to the market.	He has gone to the market.
4	Change to Future Simple: She finished her homework.	She will finish her homework.
5	Change to Past Continuous: He writes a letter.	He was writing a letter.

4. Articles (A, An, The)

4.1 Indefinite Articles: A and An

Article	Rule	Example
A	Used before words beginning with a consonant sound	a book, a university, a European
An	Used before words beginning with a vowel sound (a, e, i, o, u)	an apple, an hour, an honest man

4.2 Definite Article: The

Usage	Example
Before something already mentioned	I saw a dog. The dog was barking.
Before unique things	The sun, the moon, the earth
Before superlatives	She is the best student.
Before ordinal numbers	The first chapter, the second lesson
Before names of rivers, oceans, mountain ranges	The Ganga, the Himalayas, the Pacific
Before musical instruments	She plays the piano.

4.3 Omission of Articles

Case	Example
Before proper nouns	Shimla is beautiful. (not <i>The</i> Shimla)

Before uncountable nouns used generally	Water is essential. (not <i>The</i> water generally)
Before plural nouns used generally	Books are our best friends.
Before names of meals	I had breakfast at 8 am.
Before languages and subjects	English is a global language.

5. Prepositions

5.1 Common Prepositions with Examples

Preposition	Usage	Example
at	Specific time/place	at 5 o'clock, at the door
in	Month/year/city/country	in July, in 2026, in Delhi
on	Day/date/surface	on Monday, on 15th July, on the table
by	Agent/means/deadline	by the teacher, by bus, by Friday
for	Duration/purpose	for two hours, for you
since	From a point in time	since 2010, since morning
to	Direction/recipient	go to school, give it to him
from	Origin/source	from Shimla, from my father
with	Together/instrument	with friends, cut with a knife
between	Two items	between Ram and Shyam
among	More than two	among the students
under	Below/beneath	under the table
over	Above	over the bridge

6. Vocabulary Building

6.1 Synonyms

Word	Synonyms	Sentence
Happy	Joyful, Cheerful, Delighted, Content	She was delighted to meet you.
Big	Large, Huge, Enormous, Massive	The elephant was enormous .
Speak	Say, Tell, Talk, Utter, Communicate	Please tell me the truth.
Look	See, Watch, Observe, View, Glimpse	I can see the mountains.
Think	Believe, Consider, Contemplate, Imagine, Reflect	Please consider my proposal.

6.2 Antonyms

Word	Antonym	Word	Antonym
Above	Below	Accept	Refuse
Begin	End	Bright	Dull
Clean	Dirty	Deep	Shallow
Early	Late	Full	Empty
Happy	Sad	Hot	Cold
Light	Dark	Open	Close
Strong	Weak	Tall	Short
Warm	Cool		

6.3 Idioms

Idiom	Meaning	Sentence
Break the ice	To start a conversation	He told a joke to break the ice.
Piece of cake	Something very easy	The test was a piece of cake.
Let the cat out of the bag	Reveal a secret	She accidentally let the cat out of the bag.
Cost an arm and a leg	Very expensive	The car cost an arm and a leg.
Hit the nail on the head	Be exactly right	You hit the nail on the head.
Under the weather	Feeling unwell	I am feeling under the weather today.
Bite the bullet	Face a difficult situation	He had to bite the bullet and accept the truth.
Burn the midnight oil	Work late into the night	Students burn the midnight oil before exams.
A blessing in disguise	Something good that seemed bad	Losing his job was a blessing in disguise.
Actions speak louder than words	What you do matters more	He promises, but actions speak louder than words.

6.4 One-Word Substitution

Phrase	One Word
One who cannot read or write	Illiterate
One who knows many languages	Polyglot
One who loves books	Bibliophile

One who walks in their sleep	Somnambulist
That which cannot be seen	Invisible
That which cannot be heard	Inaudible
That which cannot be defeated	Invincible
That which lasts forever	Eternal / Perpetual

7. Common Errors in English

Incorrect	Correct	Rule
He go to school.	He goes to school.	Third person singular needs V5.
I have went there.	I have gone there.	Use V3 after have/has/had.
She don't like coffee.	She doesn't like coffee.	Use doesn't with third person singular.
He is more taller than me.	He is taller than me.	Double comparatives are incorrect.
Your shoes are more better.	Your shoes are better .	"More better" is redundant.
I and my friend went.	My friend and I went.	First person should come last.
He is having a car.	He has a car.	Possession uses "have" not "having."
Neither of them are coming.	Neither of them is coming.	Neither takes a singular verb.
The news are good.	The news is good.	"News" is uncountable, takes singular.
I prefer tea than coffee.	I prefer tea to coffee.	Prefer takes "to," not "than."

8. Practice Exercises

8.1 Fill in the Blanks (Verb Forms)

Q.No.	Question	Answer
Q1	She ____ (read) a book now.	is reading
Q2	They ____ (arrive) yesterday.	arrived
Q3	I ____ (never see) such a beautiful place.	have never seen
Q4	The phone ____ (ring) while I was cooking.	rang
Q5	He ____ (work) here for five years.	has worked / has been working
Q6	By Saturday next week, I ____ (work) on this painting for exactly one month.	will have been working
Q7	My grandparents ____ (come) to see us next weekend.	are coming
Q8	When I ____ (have) another look, I ____ (realize) the shirt had shrunk.	had, realized

8.2 Tense Conversion

Q.No.	Question	Answer
Q1	Change to Present Continuous: She sings a song.	She is singing a song.
Q2	Change to Simple Past: They go to school.	They went to school.
Q3	Change to Present Perfect: He ate the food.	He has eaten the food.

Q4	Change to Future Continuous: She writes a letter.	She will be writing a letter.
Q5	Change to Past Perfect: He leaves the room.	He had left the room.

9. Questions Section

9.1 Short Answer Questions (2-5 Marks)

1. What is a synonym? Give one example.
2. What is an antonym? Give one example.
3. What is an idiom? Give one example.
4. What is the difference between active and passive voice?
5. What is the difference between direct and indirect speech?
6. What is a tense? Name the types.
7. What is a verb? Give an example.
8. What is an adverb? Give an example.
9. What is an adjective? Give an example.
10. What is the difference between an affirmative and a negative sentence?

9.2 Long Answer Questions (10 Marks)

1. Explain the different types of tenses with examples.
2. Explain the rules for converting direct speech to indirect speech.
3. Explain the rules for converting active voice to passive voice.
4. Write 10 idioms with their meanings and sentences.
5. Explain the different types of sentences with examples.
6. Explain the difference between synonyms and antonyms with examples.

9.3 Objective Questions (1 Mark)

1. A word that has the opposite meaning is called:
(a) Synonym (b) Antonym (c) Homonym (d) None
Answer: (b)
2. A word that has the same meaning is called:
(a) Synonym (b) Antonym (c) Homonym (d) None
Answer: (a)
3. "Piece of cake" means:
(a) Difficult (b) Easy (c) Expensive (d) Cheap

Answer: (b)

4. "Break the ice" means:

(a) To break something (b) To start a conversation (c) To end a conversation (d) To leave

Answer: (b)

5. In passive voice, the subject receives the:

(a) Action (b) Object (c) Verb (d) None

Answer: (a)

6. Direct speech uses:

(a) Quotation marks (b) No quotation marks (c) Both (d) None

Answer: (a)

7. "She is writing a letter" is in:

(a) Active voice (b) Passive voice (c) Both (d) None

Answer: (a)

8. "The letter was written by her" is in:

(a) Active voice (b) Passive voice (c) Both (d) None

Answer: (b)

9.4 Key Formulas for Quick Revision

Concept	Formula
Active Voice	Subject + Verb + Object
Passive Voice	Object + be + V3 + by + Subject
Simple Present	V1 / V1 + s/es
Simple Past	V2
Simple Future	will/shall + V1

End of Unit-I Notes